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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Paralegal role at iQ Student Accommodation because the in-house legal environment appeals to me as a place to apply my practical experience directly to a commercial organisation, and my background in contract review, case file management and client-facing advice maps well onto what a growing legal function needs.

At BCLP, where I spent a year on placement split between international arbitration and real estate disputes, I worked across the full lifecycle of matters rather than on isolated tasks. In arbitration I maintained structured electronic case files, tracked procedural deadlines, coordinated document production with external translators and amended sections of a claimant's memorial. In real estate disputes I prepared electronic hearing bundles, assisted with court filings, conducted research on leasehold and landlord and tenant issues, and managed high volumes of documents across several competing matters at once. The partner and associate supervising me said my output was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor, which reflected how much independent responsibility I carried, particularly when I became the only junior on the arbitration team shortly before a significant submission deadline.

At Citizens Advice East Berkshire, where I currently advise clients on welfare benefits, housing, employment and debt matters, I manage each matter from first interview through to submission. I take factual statements, identify evidential gaps, draft correspondence and maintain confidential case records. The clients I work with are often vulnerable, so translating complex rules into clear, practical guidance quickly and accurately matters. That same discipline, understanding the relevant rules, finding the gap, explaining it plainly, is directly transferable to in-house legal support where the client is an internal team rather than an external one.

I am drawn to iQ specifically because the in-house setting means legal work is embedded in the day-to-day operation of the business. With 87 sites and 37,000 students, the kinds of legal questions that arise across property, contracts and compliance are practical and recurring rather than abstract. Having researched leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes at BCLP, and having handled housing matters at Citizens Advice, I already have some familiarity with the legal territory relevant to a student accommodation provider. This role is the right next step: a position where I can develop in-house legal skills while contributing something useful from the first week.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva